Worksheet W6 · W-Seminar "Time"

Design your study

Before you collect a single number: find the kind of data that can really answer your question – and talk your plan through.

1 My question – version 3

make version 2 from W5 testable

spark → question → working thesis → **testable claim** → thesis

Question: _____

Testable claim (hypothesis): _____

Changed since W5 – and why: _____

2 Which quality criterion is at risk?

Objectivity: same result whoever runs or scores it · **R**eliability: same result again, little noise · **V**alidity: measures what you claim. Tick the criterion that is hit first.

	O	R	V
a) You mark students' open answers yourself – without a marking key.	☐	☐	☐
b) One single question ("Are you stressed?") is your whole measure of stress.	☐	☐	☐
c) A speed-reading task is used to show how well students *understand* a novel.	☐	☐	☐
d) Group A waits before lunch, group B after lunch.	☐	☐	☐

3 Six ways to get data – brainstorm for your question

Think 4 min Fill in what each type could give you – even the odd ones; a weird idea often leads to a good one. Pair 4 min Swap sheets. Your partner ticks the option that convinces them most and writes one question in the margin.

type	what exactly could I collect?	+ / –	best?
Survey	what people say		☐
Test	what people can do		☐
Experiment	what causes what		☐
Interview	how and why		☐
Coding texts	count categories		☐
Existing data	others' statistics		☐

My partner's question: _____

4 Talk it through: partner interview

Pair 2 × 6 min Your partner asks the questions and notes your answers in keywords. Then swap roles. Don't defend – explain; "I don't know yet" is a fine answer and goes on your to-do list.

partner asks	answers (keywords)
1 What exactly do you measure – and how does it become a number or category?	
2 Who takes part, how many, and how are they chosen?	
3 What else could explain your result?	
4 Which result would show that your thesis is wrong?	
5 What could go wrong in practice – what is your plan B?	

My partner's best tip: _____

5 My design

decide – you can still change it after the pilot

☐ survey ☐ test ☐ experiment ☐ interview ☐ coding texts ☐ existing data ☐ mixed: _____

Idea → rule (operationalisation): _____

Variables / items / categories: _____

Sample (who, n, how chosen): _____

Procedure, step by step:

6 Secure the three criteria in my study

Share 1 min each Present your design to another pair. They name the biggest risk they see – add it to the table.

	biggest risk	what I do about it
Objectivity		
Reliability		
Validity		

Before I start ☐ asked my teacher ☐ school permission / parents' consent ☐ anonymous codes ☐ pilot with _____ people